In this section you'll learn how to create a custom `DataAnnotations` validation attribute that specifies specific values a `string` property may take. You'll then learn how you can expand the functionality to be more generic by delegating to a separate service that is configured in your DI controller. This will allow you to create custom domain-specific validations for your apps.

We looked at model binding in chapter 7, where you saw how to use the built-in `DataAnnotations` attributes in your binding models to validate user input. These provide several built-in validations, such as

- `[Required]`—The property isn't optional and must be provided.
- `[StringLength(min, max)]`—The length of the `string` value must be between `min` and `max` characters.
- `[EmailAddress]`—The value must have a valid email address format.

But what if these attributes don't meet your requirements? Consider the following listing, which shows a binding model from a currency converter application. The model contains three properties: the currency to convert from, the currency to convert to, and the quantity.

Listing 32.6 Currency converter initial binding model

```
public class CurrencyConverterModel
{
    [Required]                                  ❶
    [StringLength(3, MinimumLength = 3)]        ❷
    public string CurrencyFrom { get; set; }

    [Required]                                  ❶
    [StringLength(3, MinimumLength = 3)]        ❷
    public string CurrencyTo { get; set; }
```